NexaWorks

Response to RFP NW-2025-014: Vendor Onboarding Platform for Northwind Logistics

A. Executive Summary

NexaWorks proposes a configurable vendor onboarding platform that balances capability, cost and delivery certainty. We have structured the engagement around six milestones with named owners and a weekly governance cadence, so Northwind always knows where the project stands.

B. Understanding the Requirement

Northwind's procurement team spends most of its onboarding effort chasing documents and re-keying data. The need is a single front door for vendors, consistent risk checks, and a clean hand-off to finance and operations systems, delivered without disrupting current vendor relationships.

C. Solution Overview

The platform is a cloud-hosted, multi-tenant application with a modular workflow engine, a role-based access model and standard REST APIs. Prebuilt connectors cover SAP and common identity providers; other systems are integrated through the API gateway. The architecture scales horizontally and has run in production with 2,500 active vendors.

D. Data Migration, Testing and Training

We profile Northwind's vendor data in week 3, agree cleansing rules with the data owners, and run two migration rehearsals before cutover. Testing runs in three layers: automated checks in the build, a structured integration test in weeks 13 to 15, and two rounds of user acceptance testing with scenarios written together with the procurement team.

Training is role-based. Administrators receive two hands-on sessions, buyers one workshop on the approval flow, and vendors get short guides and a help page. The change manager runs a communication plan so that vendors hear about the new process at least four weeks before they are asked to use it.

- Week 3: data profiling report and cleansing rules agreed;
- Weeks 13-15: integration test cycle with Northwind IT;
- Weeks 16-19: two UAT rounds, defects triaged daily;
- Weeks 18-21: training sessions and vendor communications;
- Week 21: final cutover rehearsal and go/no-go review.

E. Implementation Plan and Governance

The 22-week plan has six milestones, each with an acceptance checklist signed by the Northwind sponsor.

Table 1 - Milestones

Milestone	Week	Owner	Acceptance
Kickoff and governance	2	Programme manager	Charter and RACI signed

Milestone	Week	Owner	Acceptance
Requirements baseline	4	Business analyst	Approved requirements
Configuration complete	10	Solution architect	Demo of all workflows
Integrations verified	15	Engineering lead	End-to-end test pass
User acceptance passed	19	QA lead	Zero open severity-1 or 2
Go-live and hypercare	22	Programme manager	Sponsor sign-off

The team of nine comprises a programme manager, a solution architect, four engineers, a business analyst, a QA lead and a change manager. A RACI matrix is agreed in week 1 and the programme manager reports progress, risks and decisions weekly.

Table 2 - RACI (R responsible, A accountable, C consulted, I informed)

Activity	Northwind	Programme mgr	Architect	QA lead
Requirements sign-off	A	R	C	I
Configuration	C	A	R	I
Integration testing	C	A	R	R
User acceptance	R	A	C	R
Go-live decision	A	R	C	C

Governance has three layers: a weekly delivery review, a monthly steering group chaired by the Northwind sponsor, and a change-control board that estimates the impact of any scope change on cost and schedule before it is accepted.

F. Security, Compliance and Risk Management

NexaWorks is SOC 2 Type II certified. Data is encrypted in transit and at rest, access is role-based with single sign-on and multi-factor authentication, and audit logs are retained for three years. Our ISO 27001 certification audit is scheduled for the second quarter. Annual third-party penetration testing is performed.

Table 3 - Top five risks

Risk	Owner	Mitigation
Poor vendor data quality	Business analyst	Profiling in week 3, cleansing sprint
Integration endpoint availability	Engineering lead	Sandbox agreed by week 6
Stakeholder capacity	Programme manager	Named Northwind delegates, weekly review
Scope growth	Programme manager	Change control with impact estimate
Go-live data migration	Solution architect	Two rehearsals before cutover

G. Service and Support Model

Support is delivered 24x7 through three tiers with a 99.9% monthly availability SLA backed by service credits. A named customer success manager runs monthly service reviews, and a 90-day hypercare period follows go-live.

Table 4 - Response targets

Severity	First response	Update cadence
1 - Service down	30 minutes	Every hour
2 - Major impairment	2 hours	Every 4 hours
3 - Minor issue	1 business day	Twice weekly

During the 90-day hypercare period an engineer is assigned to Northwind for daily check-ins, vendor questions are answered within four working hours, and a knowledge-transfer plan hands day-to-day administration to Northwind staff with recorded sessions and runbooks. After hypercare, service reviews move to monthly.

H. Pricing and Assumptions

Table 5 - Fixed price for core scope

Item	Price (USD)
Platform licence (3-year term)	390,000
Implementation	330,000
Integrations (up to four systems)	150,000
Training and change management	60,000
Support and customer success (3 years)	120,000
Total	**1,050,000**

- Prices in USD, exclusive of taxes, fixed for the core scope.
- Includes up to four system integrations.
- Optional four-week on-site hypercare is priced separately at USD 38,000.

I. Experience and References

NexaWorks has delivered six similar platforms. Brightwater Logistics (2024) onboarded 1,800 vendors and cut onboarding time from 12 days to 4. Summit Retail Group (2023) moved 900 vendors from spreadsheets in 16 weeks. Both will take reference calls.

Lessons from those projects shape this plan: we start vendor communications early, involve buyers in acceptance testing from the first round, and keep a single accountable owner for every milestone.